

Mega Drive – EverDrive Guide

Step-by-step guide, explained very simply, so anyone can use EverDrive without knowing technology.

Recommended Links

-  Recommended creator – Retro Game Corps:
[EverDrive & Mega Drive videos – Retro Game Corps](#)
If you get lost at any step, you can watch the process here.
-  Official manufacturer site:
[Official EverDrive OS download – Krikzz](#)
Always download the system from here. It is the official and safe source.

Recommended Material

Before starting, make sure you have everything ready:

 Mega EverDrive (Amazon)

 SD Card 32GB (Amazon)

 EverDrive (AliExpress)

- ✓ A working Mega Drive / Genesis.
- ✓ A Mega Drive-compatible EverDrive.
- ✓ An SD card (preferably 8–32GB, in good condition).
- ✓ A PC or laptop to copy files.

LEGAL NOTICE: This guide is intended for using backups of games you already own physically or free software. It does not support or explain how to download games illegally.

Basic Concept – What is EverDrive?

Imagine EverDrive as a **magic cartridge**. On the outside it looks like a normal cartridge, but inside it has an SD card slot.

Instead of inserting a different game each time, you put all your legal games on the SD card. The Mega Drive “believes” it has an original cartridge inserted each time.

- ✓ No need to swap cartridges constantly.
- ✓ Very fast loading times.
- ✓ You can store many games on a single card.
- ✓ Some models include extra features (save states, special menu, etc.).

Compatibility – Which consoles does it work on?

EverDrive for Mega Drive works on:

- ✓ Sega Mega Drive / Genesis (Model 1, 2 and 3).
- ✓ Sega Nomad.
- ✓ Sega TeraDrive / Amstrad Mega PC.
- ✓ Analogue Mega Sg.
- ⚠ Some cheap clone consoles may have issues (not EverDrive’s fault).

Required Material (quick summary)

- 📦 An EverDrive cartridge (X3, X5, X7 or Pro).
- 💾 An SD or microSD card (depending on EverDrive model).
- 🖨 A PC with SD card reader.
- 🔌 Power cable and video cable for your Mega Drive.

1

Prepare the SD card

This step is very important. If the SD card is not prepared correctly, EverDrive will not work.

1. Connect the SD card to the PC. If it has no slot, use a USB adapter.
2. Format the card in **FAT32**. In Windows: right-click the card → "Format" → File system: FAT32 → Start.
3. When finished, open the card and create a folder named MEGA. Type the name exactly like this: **MEGA** (uppercase).
4. Go to the official Krikzz website and download the Mega EverDrive OS. Extract the file and copy all contents into the MEGA folder.
5. Check that inside MEGA you see files like `mdos.bin`. If you see nothing, you didn't copy the content correctly.
6. Create another folder in the SD root named ROMS. Your legal game backups go there.

2 First boot with EverDrive

Now we will use the SD card in the console.

1. Make sure the Mega Drive is **off**.
2. Insert the SD card fully into the EverDrive.
3. Insert the EverDrive into the Mega Drive cartridge slot.
4. Turn on the console.
5. If everything is correct, you will see the EverDrive logo and then a list of folders and files.
6. Use the D-pad to navigate and enter the ROMS folder.
7. Choose a game and press **C** or **Start** to load it.

```
MEGA EVERDRIVE OS v3.12
-----
> [DIRECTORY] MEGA
> [DIRECTORY] ROMS
- Sonic_the_Hedgehog.bin
- Streets_of_Rage_2.bin

[A] OPTIONS [B] BACK [C] SELECT
```

If you see something like this screen, everything is working correctly.

3 How game saves work

Not all EverDrive models save games the same way. It is important to understand this to avoid losing progress.

- **X3 / X5 models:**

When you finish playing:

- First press the console's **Reset** button.
- Wait a few seconds.
- Then turn off the console.

If you turn off directly without pressing Reset, the save may not be written to the SD.

- **X7 / Pro models:**

These models save automatically when exiting or turning off the console. Some allow using a special in-game menu to manage saves.

Common Errors and How to Fix Them

Error 0xF1 – SD initialization failed

EverDrive cannot read the SD card.

Steps to check:

- Ensure the card is formatted in **FAT32**.
- Try a card of 32GB or less.
- Copy the OS again into the MEGA folder.

Quick tip: If the console shows a red or black screen at startup:

- Clean the EverDrive's gold contacts with a cotton swab and isopropyl alcohol.
- Make sure the cartridge is fully inserted.

Optimization and Useful Tips

- 🎮 **Master System games:**

Many Mega Drive EverDrives allow playing Master System games directly, without extra adapters.

- 💾 **Save States:**

Only available on advanced models (X7 / Pro). They allow saving at any moment from a special menu.

- ⚡ **SD organization:**

Keep your games organized in folders (by genre, alphabetically, etc.) to find everything faster.